

Job hunt research

Yes — several of these organizations are actively running programs that need coding and web development instructors, though the opportunities vary between formal hiring, volunteer mentoring, and direct outreach.

Most Active: Swisscontact / Digital Literacy Initiative (DLI)

This is your most promising lead. The Digital Literacy Initiative (funded by The Dariu Foundation, implemented by Swisscontact, and partnered with MoEYS) is currently running across Siem Reap and Battambang provinces through 2025. It has already trained 110+ teachers in coding (Scratch, Micro:bit), established 8 Code Clubs, and reached 4,000+ students.

While their model focuses on Training-of-Trainers, they work with Tech for Kids Academy as a technical delivery partner and have previously hired Project Officers to guide schools, animate coding clubs, and support teachers.

Swisscontact Cambodia directs job seekers to their Facebook page "Swisscontact Cambodia" for current recruitment. Given that the program is scaling and recently held a national Code Club showcase (December 2025), they may need additional technical trainers or curriculum developers as they expand.

Dariu Foundation: Industry Mentor Program

The Dariu Foundation explicitly recruits "volunteering mentors from the industry" (including from Google, Microsoft, Intel, Qualcomm) to coach their top students through Entrepreneurship Courses and Business Plan Contests. Their Cambodia program is growing rapidly, and they are looking to build a pipeline from basic coding → Code Clubs → entrepreneurship. If you're open to a volunteer or part-time mentorship role, this is worth contacting directly.

NGOs with Active Trainer Roles

- PSE (Pour un Sourire d'Enfant) currently lists a Web and Apps Development Trainer role in Phnom Penh. The posting notes that teaching experience is not required — they are looking for someone who can design and deliver practical training.
- Passerelles numériques (PN Cambodia) has historically hired Web Programming Trainers for their two-year vocational program serving underprivileged youth.
- IT Step Cambodia has a part-time, flexible Web Apps Development Trainer position (PHP/MsSQL) in Phnom Penh.

KOOMPI & CTEP: No Public Listings, but Direct Outreach May Work

I did not find current public job postings from KOOMPI or CTEP for traveling instructors. However, CTEP's operational model historically relies on volunteers from Taiwan, Hong Kong, Malaysia and China to manage and supervise their 22 rural learning centers across the country. KOOMPI's Sala Camp initiative is scaling to new displacement sites and rural schools, and they may need technical facilitators even if roles aren't publicly advertised.

Practical Next Steps

1. Check Swisscontact Cambodia's Facebook page — this is where they post current openings.
2. Email The Dariu Foundation directly about their mentor/volunteer pipeline; they are actively building Cambodia's program.
3. Apply to PSE's Web and Apps Development Trainer role if you want immediate, paid work.

4. Cold-email KOOMPI (info@koompi.com or their team) mentioning your interest in supporting Sala Camp deployments — they are hardware-focused and may value a front-end specialist who understands low-bandwidth environments.
5. Reach out to CTEP about their rural learning center network; they have a history of using international volunteers.

Your specific expertise in low-bandwidth front-end development is a genuine differentiator here — most Cambodian ed-tech initiatives struggle with connectivity and device limitations, and very few instructors have 20 years of UI/UX experience tuned for constrained environments. That combination of technical depth and practical optimization is exactly what these programs lack.

Yes — there are several NGOs and initiatives that specifically build computer labs in poor, rural provinces and run ongoing teaching programs for kids. Here are the most relevant ones:

1. CTEP — Cambodia Team for Education Program Organization

This is one of the largest networks of its kind. CTEP operates 35 learning centers across poor and rural provinces including Battambang, Siem Reap, Kampong Thom, Svay Rieng, Kampong Chhnang, and Banteay Meanchey. They have two models:

- Self-Managed Learning Centers (MLCs) — afternoon/evening classes for public school students, teaching computer literacy and English. CTEP creates the curriculum, hires and trains instructors, and monitors students.
- Co-Managed Learning Centers (CLCs) — set up inside public schools and NGO classrooms where CTEP provides the computers, textbooks, and teaching allowances, while the school assigns teachers and students. CTEP visits regularly to supervise and troubleshoot.

They currently manage 20 active centers (10 MLCs, 10 CLCs), all teaching computer skills and/or English. They have a history of using international volunteers and seed teachers from Taiwan and the region.

2. Aide et Action — Primary Learning Program (PLP) Labs

Aide et Action is actively setting up computer labs in rural primary schools to support Cambodia's new Primary Learning Program. A recent example is Thkol Andet Primary School in Pursat province, where they provided 15 computers and helped establish internet connectivity.

The teacher there specifically said: "In case our partners or donors wish to contribute, they can also consider providing capacity building to develop specific digital skills" — meaning they need people who can teach beyond basic government curriculum. Aide et Action aims to reach 200 to 500 schools with PLP action labs in the next two years.

3. ChildFund Cambodia — Easy 2 Learn (Kratie Province)

ChildFund's multi-year project has transformed 17 schools in Kratie Province — one of Cambodia's poorest and most remote regions. They have built 3 computer labs, provided 17 laptops and 294 tablets, and trained teachers on child-friendly digital lessons. They also built 7 libraries and renovated classrooms. The focus is on literacy and numeracy, but the tech infrastructure and teacher training are central.

4. Cambodia Rural Schools Program

This long-running project has constructed more than 550 schools in rural Cambodia. Donors can "adopt" an existing school and add:

- Computer labs with desktop computers and Khmer-language keyboards
- Solar panels to power the lab (since many villages are off-grid)
- Internet access via GPRS or ADSL

- Daily English and computer training programs with dedicated instructors

They explicitly seek sponsors to fund English and computer training at rural schools that would otherwise have none.

5. Cambodian Children's Trust (CCT) — Battambang

CCT partnered with Grok Learning and the Atlassian Foundation to bring ICT education to Battambang. Rather than building standalone labs, they integrate ICT education into existing community structures.

6. Child's Dream / Sunline Foundation

Child's Dream helps renovate existing classrooms into computer labs — for example, equipping a lab with 31 desktop computers at a rural school. They work on a project-by-project basis in underserved areas.

7. Kamboo Project — Siem Reap

The Kamboo Project completed an expansion of four school computer labs in Prasat Bakong district, Siem Reap Province, working directly with rural schools to build out lab infrastructure.

8. PEPY Empowering Youth — Siem Reap

PEPY is an ongoing program supported by donors like Child's Dream that works in Siem Reap Province, including boarding houses and computer labs for rural high school students.

Which ones need instructors?

- CTEP is the most established network and historically uses international volunteers and seed teachers. They have 20 active centers and a system for training and placing instructors.
- Aide et Action is scaling fast (200–500 schools) and the on-the-ground teachers are explicitly asking for capacity-building partners who can teach specific digital skills beyond the basic curriculum.
- Cambodia Rural Schools Program allows donors to fund dedicated English and computer instructors at adopted schools — if you connected with them as a program sponsor or instructor, you could be placed at a specific rural school.
- ChildFund focuses on teacher training rather than bringing in outside instructors, but their Kratie labs could be entry points for specialized workshops.

Your background in low-bandwidth front-end development is especially relevant for the Cambodia Rural Schools Program and Aide et Action labs, because many of these rural schools have limited or GPRS-only internet — exactly the constrained environment you specialize in optimizing for.

Yes — there is a clear divide between established web development programs (mostly in Phnom Penh and private institutions) and a much larger wave of schools actively expanding into STEM/tech that need instructors, curriculum, and equipment. Here is the landscape:

Schools Already Teaching Web Development

Universities with formal web dev tracks:

- Paññāsāstra University of Cambodia (PUC) — Computer Science program includes Multimedia and Web Design, Website Development and Application, and Mobile Application Development as required courses in the third year.
- University of Cambodia — College of Science and Technology teaches Web Development I (JavaScript) and Web Development II (PHP) as core major courses.

Private academies and bootcamps:

- IT Academy STEP Cambodia — Runs structured web development courses (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Bootstrap, Sass) for both adults and children. They also operate Sisters of Code, a girls' coding club backed by the Ministry of Education that teaches website development at New Generation Sisowath School.
- DEVSKILL Academy, Code Cambodia, Nucamp, SEATECH Coding Hub, Techpreneur Bootcamp — Private bootcamps teaching full-stack and front-end web development. These are market-driven and growing rapidly to meet a projected shortage of 600,000 IT professionals.

Schools and Programs Expanding into STEM / Tech (Where the Need Is)

This is the larger opportunity. Multiple initiatives are converting traditional schools into STEM-focused institutions but lack qualified instructors and curriculum depth:

1. ADB 70M Upper Secondary STEM Reform

The Asian Development Bank is funding a major project to upgrade 117 upper secondary schools across Cambodia (14 network schools + 103 general schools). Each school is converting three classrooms into two science labs and one library with STEM equipment, teaching materials, and education technology. The project will provide continuous professional development to 775 STEM teachers, with a goal of integrating 21st-century skills into the national curriculum.

2. Swisscontact / Digital Literacy Initiative (DLI)

Actively embedding coding into the formal school system. They are working with 4 high schools and 5 TVET schools in Siem Reap and Battambang to:

- Complement existing computer labs
- Develop coding and digital entrepreneurship curriculum
- Train teachers to run coding classes and Coding Clubs
- Establish a framework so schools can independently run these programs after the project ends

This is explicitly about institutional expansion — turning regular high schools into schools that teach coding.

3. Caring for Cambodia (CFC)

Operates junior and senior high schools where all schools now have fully equipped technology labs. The Ministry of Education points to CFC schools as the national model for STEM skills integration. They are actively investing in "skilled coordinators, program managers, and specialized teachers" and creating/sharing curriculum through conferences and open training.

4. Government Digital Schools Program & Primary Learning Program (Aide et Action)

The government is running a Digital Schools Program to equip schools with modern IT infrastructure. Separately, Aide et Action is rolling out Primary Learning Program labs to 200–500 schools, with teachers explicitly asking for "capacity building to develop specific digital skills" beyond the basic curriculum.

5. Cambodia Rural Schools Program

Allows donors to adopt rural schools and add computer labs, solar power, internet, and daily English/computer training programs. This is a modular way for individual schools to grow into tech-enabled institutions one by one.

The Instructor Gap

A 2025 CDRI study confirms the core problem: Cambodia has a significant shortage of qualified STEM teachers, insufficient training, and limited resources. While Continuous Professional Development (CPD) programs exist, they are mostly short workshops and in-school training sessions driven by project interventions — not deep, sustained technical instruction.

A VSO volunteer advisor working in Cambodian schools noted that ICT provision is still in its early stages, maintenance is an issue, and there is a lack of science technicians — but also that the majority of teachers are keen to develop and grateful for support.

Where You Fit

The schools and programs most likely to need someone with your background are:

DLI (Swisscontact) — Coding club facilitators and curriculum developers for high schools/TVETs. Front-end + low-bandwidth optimization fits their rural/provincial school focus.

Caring for Cambodia — Specialized STEM teachers and curriculum coordinators. Their model schools need depth beyond basic ICT.

ADB STEM Reform schools — STEM teacher trainers (775 teachers being upskilled). Web dev is a 21st-century skill they want integrated.

Aide et Action PLP labs — Capacity builders for specific digital skills. Teachers explicitly asked for this.

Cambodia Rural Schools Program — Dedicated computer instructors at adopted schools. Your low-bandwidth expertise is directly applicable.

The universities and bootcamps already have structured programs and staff. The real opening is with the expanding STEM schools — particularly under the ADB reform, DLI, and Caring for Cambodia — where institutions are being retrofitted for tech but lack people who can actually teach web development at a professional level.

Yes — there are several schools and programs in Cambodia that explicitly run STEAM (Science, Technology, Engineering, Arts, Mathematics) curricula or are building out creative-technology departments where art, design, code, and English intersect. Here are the best fits:

International Schools with Active STEAM Programs

CIA FIRST International School (Phnom Penh)

This is the strongest match for your skill set. CIA FIRST runs a full STEAM curriculum from middle school through high school with the Arts and Technology explicitly integrated:

- Core subjects: Mathematics, Science, and Computer Science Principles (following ISTE and CSS standards)
- Electives: Robotics, Visual and Performing Arts, and Music
- AP offerings: AP 2D Arts and Design, AP 3D Arts and Design, AP Computer Science, and AP Computer Science Principles

Their program is built around inquiry-based, student-centered learning that connects tech and arts to real-world Cambodian contexts. The school is WASC-accredited, has 5,500 students across three campuses, and embeds technology throughout the curriculum. If you want a role where you can move between art, design, and code within one institution, this is it.

Shrewsbury International School Phnom Penh

Shrewsbury is building a massive new all-through campus in Sen Sok (opening September 2026) with dedicated design and technology workshops, art studios, drama studios, and a 600-seat theatre. They currently have an active job posting for a Secondary Teacher of Art & Design Technology — a role that sits exactly at the intersection of art, design, and making. As the school scales from primary through secondary, they will need staff who can bridge creative and technical disciplines.

Northbridge International School Cambodia (NISC)

NISC is part of the Nord Anglia network and explicitly promotes STEAM as a multidisciplinary approach, integrating science, technology, engineering, arts, and mathematics across the curriculum. They have the resources and pedagogical framework for cross-disciplinary teaching.

BELTEI International School

BELTEI has launched dedicated STEAM and Robotics programs as part of its modern education push. While details on arts integration are lighter, the fact that they are branding under STEAM rather than pure STEM suggests room for creative-technology instructors.

Bromsgrove International School Cambodia (BISC)

BISC is hiring a STEM / Robotics / PBL / Innovation Teacher for primary level. The role requires delivering coding, robotics, and digital tools through project-based learning, plus leading co-curricular activities like STEM clubs and design challenges. This is a tech-heavy role but sits within a British international school that values innovation and cross-curricular work.

National Programs That Combine Art, Code, and Design

UNICEF Game Changers Coalition — 33 Schools Across 5 Provinces

This is a government-backed STEAM initiative that uses video game creation as the entry point for coding, design, storytelling, and problem-solving. It is active in Battambang, Siem Reap, Stung Treng, Takeo, and Kampot provinces.

Students learn to identify community issues, research solutions, and build games around them — which means they need instruction in:

- Coding (game development tools and fundamentals)
- Design (visual and UX for games)
- Storytelling / English (narrative and pitching)
- Art (assets, characters, environments)

In 2024, the Ministry trained 100 leading teachers (one life skills teacher and one ICT teacher per school) in a five-day intensive on game development education. The program is expanding and explicitly seeks mentors and industry specialists. Cambodian students from this program recently won four of seven global award categories at the first UNICEF Game Jam.

If you approached UNICEF Cambodia or MoEYS as a mentor or curriculum consultant, your combined art + code + English background would be highly relevant — especially for rural schools where students are building games about local issues like conservation and health.

Makerspaces and Creative Technology Hubs

The TinkerLab (Phnom Penh)

A digital-traditional makerspace for Khmer youth that blends microcontrollers, 3D printing, and electronics with traditional Cambodian crafts. It is designed as an incubator of exchange between technology and local craftsmanship. This is a grassroots, community-based space rather than a formal school, but it is exactly the kind of environment where someone with art, design, and code skills could teach, mentor, or help build curriculum.

CADT Makerspace

The Cambodia Academy of Digital Technology runs a makerspace open to kids, adults, and entrepreneurs with 3D printers, laser cutters, CNC machines, and soldering equipment. While more tech-focused, it is a hub for creative technology education in Phnom Penh.

University-Level Creative Tech Programs

University of Cambodia — School of Creative Arts

Their Bachelor of Drama program includes Creative Technology as a required major course, plus Computer-Generated Music I & II. Their design and architecture programs also teach Computer Graphic Design (3DS MAX), AutoCAD, and foundational computing. While these are higher-ed programs, they indicate that Cambodian institutions are actively seeking instructors who can teach arts and technology together.

Where You Fit Best

Given your specific combination of art, design, English, and code plus low-bandwidth optimization expertise, the best targets are:

CIA FIRST International School — They already have the AP courses and STEAM framework. You could realistically teach AP 2D/3D Arts and Design, AP Computer Science Principles, and contribute to their Computer Science and Robotics electives. The school is large, growing, and explicitly values technology embedded across arts and academics.

Shrewsbury International School Phnom Penh — They are actively hiring for Art & Design Technology and building a new campus with dedicated maker workshops. A new campus launch means they are staffing up and open to defining new roles.

UNICEF Game Changers Coalition / MoEYS — As a mentor or curriculum developer for their 33-school game-development network. This gets you into rural and provincial schools (Takeo, Kampot, Battambang, etc.) rather than just Phnom Penh, and game design is inherently interdisciplinary.

The TinkerLab or CADT Makerspace — If you prefer informal, community-based teaching or want to run workshops that blend traditional Cambodian art with web design and creative coding.

Your background is unusual in Cambodia — most tech teachers are pure CS, and most art teachers are pure fine arts. The ability to move across art, design, English, and code within a single role is exactly what these STEAM programs are trying to build but rarely find in one person.

Yes — there are concrete options, and one in particular is almost tailor-made for your background.

Phare Ponleu Selpak — Visual and Applied Arts School (Battambang)

This is the strongest match. Phare is a well-known Cambodian NGO arts organization in Battambang (a provincial city, not Phnom Penh) that runs the Visual and Applied Arts School (VAAS). It is a vocational art school offering professional training in graphic design, animation, and visual arts.

Their 24-month Graphic Design specialty covers:

- Illustrator, InDesign, Photoshop
- Packaging, Typography, Photography
- Creative Design, Sketch-Up
- Motion Graphics
- English (64 hours in the common core)

- Computer fundamentals

They have 40+ computers with graphic design software, a photo studio, and a social enterprise (Phare Creative Studio) that hires graduates. They claim a 100% graduate employment rate and maintain relationships with over 50 companies across Cambodia.

Most importantly: they are actively hiring. As of February 2026, Phare Ponleu Selpak has an open vacancy for a Graphic Design Lead Teacher to work under the Principal of VAAS. They also regularly take on volunteers and teacher assistants for graphic design roles.

This sits at the intersection of everything you mentioned: art, design, English, and code-adjacent digital skills — in a provincial NGO setting rather than a Phnom Penh private school.

Government TVET Institutes in Poor Provinces

Cambodia's Ministry of Labor runs a network of Provincial Training Centers and Polytechnic Institutes that offer Graphic Design as a formal Technical and Vocational Certificate program. These are specifically located outside Phnom Penh and serve poorer populations:

- Kampong Speu Provincial Training Center — Graphic Design, Computer Service
- Koh Kong Provincial Training Center — Graphic Design
- Battambang Institute of Technology — Graphic Design certificate
- Regional Polytechnic Institute Techo Sen Takeo — Graphic Design
- National Institute of Entrepreneurship and Innovation (Phnom Penh) — Publishing and Graphic Design
- National Polytechnic Institute of Angkor (Siem Reap area) — Computer Graphic Design
- Polytechnic Institute of Preah Sihanouk — Computer Graphic Design
- National Vocation Institute of Battambang — Various vocational programs

These institutes are government-run, often under-resourced, and their graphic design curricula may be basic compared to Phare or private academies. However, they are explicitly mandated to serve poor and rural youth, and they are legally required to meet labor market needs. If you approached one of these provincial centers as a curriculum consultant or guest instructor, there is likely room to deepen their offerings — especially since many list graphic design but lack teachers with professional industry experience.

Small NGO: COPE Cambodia (Banteay Meanchey)

COPE (Cambodian Organization for Progress and Education) is a grassroots NGO in Serei Sophon District, Banteay Meanchey Province — a poor, border province. They run language and computer classes for children in difficult circumstances, and Graphic Design is explicitly listed among their computer skills offerings. This is a much smaller operation than Phare, but it is exactly the kind of rural NGO classroom setup you asked about earlier.

Private Academies (Phnom Penh)

If you are open to Phnom Penh, two active graphic design programs are hiring practitioner-teachers:

- IT Academy STEP Cambodia — Runs a 2.5-year Computer Graphics and Design program covering Photoshop, Illustrator, UI/UX, web design, 3D modeling, video editing, and special effects. They emphasize that their teachers are industry practitioners and they build student portfolios. Alumni work as UX/UI designers, graphic designers, and multimedia designers across Cambodia.

- Instinct Institute — Offers professional Graphic Design with Photoshop and Illustrator, plus UI/UX and front-end web development tracks. They market themselves as a top digital skills institute in Phnom Penh.

Universities with Formal Graphic Design Degrees

- Royal University of Fine Arts (RUFA) — Bachelor through PhD in Fine Arts with a Graphic Design specialization. This is the country's flagship public arts university.

- Limkokwing University of Creative Technology — Bachelor and Master of Arts in Graphic Design (Visual Communication, Multimedia Design, Advertising Design).

- Paññāsāstra University (PUC) — Landscape and Interior Design program includes Computer Graphic Design (3DS MAX, AutoCAD), though this is architecture-focused rather than pure graphic design.

Where You Fit Best

If you want to teach graphic design in a poor province / NGO / arts-school context, the hierarchy is:

1. Apply to Phare Ponleu Selpak's Graphic Design Lead Teacher role — This is an active vacancy at a respected provincial NGO arts school. Your combined art + design + English + front-end background is stronger than a pure graphic designer's resume because their curriculum touches web, UI/UX, and English.

2. Contact a Provincial TVET Center (Kampong Speu, Koh Kong, Takeo, Battambang) — Offer to consult on or teach their graphic design certificate. These schools exist but often lack instructors with real industry experience.

3. COPE Cambodia — If you want a very small, grassroots NGO in a poor province (Banteay Meanchey) where you could shape a graphic design program from scratch.

4. IT Academy STEP — If you want a paid, structured teaching role in Phnom Penh with a curriculum already built.

The Phare opportunity is the most immediate and the best cultural fit: it is an NGO, it is in a province, it treats design as a vocational survival skill for poor students, and they are hiring right now.

Yes — and there is one active job that is almost a direct match, plus a major arts NGO where your digital audio skills would fill a clear gap.

Smiling Gecko School — Music Teacher (Kampong Chhnang Province)

This is the most immediate opportunity. Smiling Gecko is a Swiss-backed NGO development project in rural Kampong Chhnang Province (not Phnom Penh). They run a K–8 school for over 500 children from poor families and are actively hiring a Music Teacher for the 2025–2026 school year with an August 2026 start.

What they want:

- Bachelor's degree in Music or Music Education
- PGCE or teaching license preferred
- TESOL certification
- Native English speaker or B2–C1 level
- Experience designing and implementing music/choir curriculum
- Video examples of performances and teaching sessions are very preferred

What they offer:

- 20,000 USD tax-free net salary per annum
- International health insurance, work permit, visa
- Accommodation, three meals per day, laundry, cleaning
- Weekend shuttle bus to Phnom Penh
- Moving costs covered

This is a general music role, not specifically digital audio production. But the school is growing by 50 students per year, and they also hire a Pedagogic ICT Support Teacher to integrate technology into lessons. If you applied for the music role and proposed adding a digital audio production elective — or even just brought synthesis and DAW-based composition into general music classes — you would likely be the only candidate offering that combination.

Phare Ponleu Selpak — Performing Arts School & Creative Studio (Battambang)

Phare is Cambodia's best-known arts NGO, based in Battambang. Their Performing Arts School includes a Music department alongside Circus, Theatre, and Dance, with free classes for disadvantaged children ages 6 through adult vocational levels.

More importantly, Phare explicitly mentions audio production in their staffing. A recent job posting for a Music School Assistant Coordinator listed "additional training in areas like audio production, legal aspects of music, etc." as part of the role.

Additionally, Phare runs Phare Creative Studio — a social enterprise that offers professional services in graphic design, video, sound, and 2D animation. This means there is both an educational pipeline (training young artists) and a commercial outlet (the studio) where sound and audio production skills are used professionally.

Phare's music tradition is rooted in Cambodian performing arts and circus, but their vocational track and creative studio suggest room for someone to introduce digital music production, sound design for performance, or audio post-production as either a class or a mentorship stream. Your background in synthesis design and DAW workflow would be genuinely new there.

The Reality on the Ground

Digital audio production — especially electronic music, beatmaking, and synthesis — is not yet a standard subject in Cambodian schools or even most arts NGOs. Most music education, even at progressive institutions like Phare, is oriented toward:

- Traditional Cambodian instruments and performance
- Western classical/orchestral training
- Circus and theatre accompaniment

Reason and Maschine specifically are virtually unknown in Cambodia; Ableton Live and Logic Pro are what commercial courses teach (for example, The Knowledge Academy runs a Music Production Masterclass in Phnom Penh focused on Ableton and Logic).

However, your underlying skills are highly transferable. Synthesis design, drum programming, sampling, and arrangement workflow translate across DAWs. The value you bring is not the specific software — it is the ability to teach digital composition, sound design, and production in a country where most music teachers have never touched a MIDI controller or a subtractive synth.

Where You Fit Best

Apply to Smiling Gecko as their Music Teacher — it is a real, funded, rural NGO position with a start date in August 2026. Propose adding digital audio production and music technology to their curriculum. They are already hiring for ICT integration support, so they are open to tech-in-education.

Contact Phare Ponleu Selpak — ask about their Music School's vocational track and Creative Studio's sound department. Offer to develop a digital audio production module or mentor students on synthesis and DAW-based composition. Their job posting already named audio production as a training need.

Approach Phare Creative Studio directly — if you also have audio engineering or sound-for-video skills, they may have freelance or contract work mixing and producing sound for their video and animation projects, which could lead to a teaching role.

Your combination of music performance (guitar, bass, keys), music production (DAW, synthesis), and English fluency is rare in Cambodia. Most music teachers are either traditional performers or Western classical instructors. Someone who can teach kids to write beats, design synth patches, and produce finished tracks in English is essentially a unicorn in the Cambodian education market.

Yes — and this is arguably the most open field of all. Cambodia is in the middle of a national push to digitize its education system, but the gap between policy and implementation is wide. That gap is where someone with your technical background fits.

Schools Looking for Technical Upgrades

Cambodia has a massive infrastructure deficit. Two-thirds of high school students do not have access to computers, and government school students in rural areas face the worst hardware and connectivity shortages. The government itself acknowledges that many schools lack broadband, computer labs, and basic technical support staff.

Where the need is concrete:

- New Generation Schools are required by government policy to have operational computer labs, e-library services with tablets, educational software, teacher laptops, and LCD projectors. Schools with over 25 classes must have at least three computer labs. Yet many are struggling to meet these standards.
- Aide et Action Cambodia has set up computer labs in more than 120 schools and explicitly works with the Ministry of Education each year to identify "committed schools" to support with digital tools and teacher training. They are actively looking for partner schools that want to upgrade but need external technical help.
- UNICEF and EdTech Hub are supporting the Ministry of Education to craft a national digital education strategy, running workshops with school directors from various provinces to validate what schools actually need. The recurring theme: schools are at wildly different digital development stages and need modular, practical support — not just policy documents.

If you approached Aide et Action, UNICEF Cambodia, or the Ministry's Department of Policy directly as a technical consultant who can assess school infrastructure, recommend low-bandwidth solutions, and help deploy them, you would be filling a documented need.

Teaching Teachers How to Use AI

This is a national priority with almost no experienced trainers on the ground yet.

What is happening now:

- In February 2026, Cambodia held its first National AI for Education Conference. The Ministry of Education (MoEYS) and UNESCO announced they are developing an ICT and AI Competency Framework for Teachers — a national roadmap for training teachers in AI literacy, ethical usage, and classroom integration. This is part of STEPCam Phase II, a 27.02 million teacher education program.
- The Research Center on AI for Education (RAIE) was inaugurated at the Cambodia Academy of Digital Technology (CADT). It is explicitly tasked with:
 - Providing AI training to teachers, researchers, and students
 - Developing AI solutions for teaching and learning
 - Building national capacity in AI policy, ethics, and pedagogy
- In October 2025, MoEYS launched two AI-powered education apps (EdTech App and Primary Learning Program) under the theme "Teachers as the Catalyst of AI Transformation." Teachers are being encouraged to use AI for lesson planning, exercise preparation, and student assessment tracking.
- The Knowledge Academy in Cambodia now offers an "AI for Educators" training course covering prompt creation and ethical usage, which indicates there is emerging market demand.

The gap: There are very few people in Cambodia who can actually train teachers on AI tools in a practical, hands-on way. Most initiatives are still at the policy or framework stage. If you offered workshops to provincial teacher training centers or directly to clusters of rural schools on how to use AI for lesson planning, assessment, and even basic coding/music production, you would likely be the first specialist many of these teachers have encountered.

Schools / NGOs That Need Custom Software Tools

This is less visible but very real. Large NGOs in Cambodia often build or adapt their own internal systems because off-the-shelf tools do not fit local constraints (Khmer language support, offline functionality, low bandwidth, specific reporting requirements for donors).

Documented example:

- Cambodian Children's Fund (CCF) — one of Cambodia's largest education NGOs caring for 1,800+ students — actively hires Software Developers to build and modify in-house software applications, back-end integrations, and custom reporting solutions. They posted a developer role as recently as mid-2024.

Where else this need exists:

- MoEYS is pushing for a national data center, e-learning platforms, and adaptive testing systems. The EdTech App they launched includes a national adaptive testing system and student progress tracking — all of which require ongoing development, maintenance, and UX refinement.

- Aide et Action runs digital education platforms and PLP labs across 120+ schools. These systems require custom dashboards, offline-capable content delivery, and teacher-facing tools.

- Phare Creative Studio and other NGO social enterprises occasionally need web-based tools, internal databases, and digital asset management systems.

- Provincial TVET centers and polytechnics are supposed to modernize curricula with digital components but often lack the software infrastructure to manage student records, portfolios, or online learning modules.

Your front-end and UI/UX expertise, combined with your understanding of low-bandwidth environments, is exactly what these organizations lack. Most Cambodian software developers are back-end focused or work on generic web apps. Someone who can design lightweight, intuitive interfaces for teachers and students on slow connections — and who can also train those teachers to use the tools — is a rare combination.

How to Approach This

If you want to pursue the technical upgrade / AI training / custom software angle:

1. Contact RAIE at CADT — they are the national hub for AI in education and explicitly want to build capacity. Offer to run teacher AI literacy workshops or consult on practical classroom AI tools.

2. Reach out to Aide et Action Cambodia — they are actively identifying schools for digital tool support and teacher training. Position yourself as a technical trainer who can both upgrade infrastructure and train teachers on AI and digital tools.

3. Email UNICEF Cambodia's EdTech team — they are deep in the digital education strategy rollout and need implementers, not just policymakers.

4. Check NGO job boards (BongThom, NGO Forum Cambodia, Devex) for Software Developer or ICT Consultant roles at education NGOs like CCF, World Vision Cambodia, or Save the Children.
5. Offer a bundled service to provincial school clusters — technical audit + low-bandwidth upgrade plan + teacher AI training + lightweight custom tools. Cambodia's New Generation School policy creates the demand, but individual schools have no one to deliver it.

The policy momentum is there, the funding is flowing through UNESCO and GPE, and the schools are eager. What is missing is people on the ground who can actually do the work.

Yes — and this is actually one of the most undersupplied niches in Cambodian education right now. The gap between policy ambition and actual curriculum is wide, and several organizations are actively trying to close it.

Active Curriculum Development Roles

REACH Siem Reap Organisation

This NGO is currently hiring a full curriculum development team for their Youth Empowerment Through Digital Literacy project. They have four open positions:

- Lead Computer Literacy Curriculum Developer (700–1,200) — oversees comprehensive digital literacy curriculum for grades 7–9
- Computer Literacy Curriculum Developer (400–600) — designs digital literacy courses
- Assistant Curriculum Developer (280–400) — supports curriculum design for grades 7–9
- Digital Learning and Tech Coordinator (900–1,200) — manages LMS deployment and digitalized course content

All roles require designing courses that will be hosted on a Learning Management System with integrated monitoring and evaluation tools. They specifically want people with education/NGO sector experience who can explain complex tech topics in simple terms.

Asian Development Bank — STEP-UP Project

The ADB is funding a 70M+ upper secondary STEM reform and is hiring an International STEM Specialist on an intermittent consulting basis (24 person-months over 3 years, 2024–2028). This is not a classroom teaching role — it is pure curriculum and systems architecture:

- Develop a school-based STEM Framework for implementation across target upper secondary schools
- Co-lead the design of a continuous professional development (CPD) program for teacher-educators and STEM subject teachers
- Advise on the Cambodia Science and Technology Center (CSTC) design
- Update lab safety systems, teacher guidelines, and safety video content
- Ensure Gender Action Plan integration into STEM curriculum

This is high-level curriculum design work at the national policy level.

Government-Level Curriculum Gaps

Ministry of Education (MoEYS) — Strategic Plan 2024-2028

The ministry's own strategic plan identifies curriculum development as a critical institutional capacity gap. Specific areas where they need curriculum modernization:

- Digital technology programs — target of 28 programs developed/revised by 2028 (baseline: 16 in 2023)
- Green technology and digital skills — curricula must be updated to meet labor market needs
- Outcome-Based Education (OBE) framework — needs curriculum design guidelines and associated training for higher education institutions
- ICT integration — teacher capacity to design lesson content, produce learning materials, and use digital classrooms

The plan explicitly states: "There are still a few numbers of senior professionals who do not meet the needs of the present and the future" and calls for systematic capacity building in curriculum development, teaching methodology, and ICT for education.

Higher Education — No Standard ICT Curriculum

An Asia Foundation/USAID assessment found that Cambodian higher education institutions have no standard ICT curriculum across universities. Each institution sets its own priorities, resulting in inconsistent course offerings. Students themselves requested curriculum additions including:

- Web Development
- Software Engineering
- 3D and 4D Design
- Animation
- Digital Marketing
- Social Media Skills
- IT Security

The report specifically recommended shifting curriculum development culture to include student and market input, rather than leaving it solely to administrators.

A separate CDRI study confirmed that subjects related to machine learning, AI, fintech, and data science are "limited and almost non-existent" in ICT curricula, even as global demand rises.

NGO Programs Scaling Up That Need Curriculum

Swisscontact / Digital Literacy Initiative (DLI)

DLI is embedding coding and digital literacy into four high schools and four TVET institutes across Battambang and Siem Reap. They have already reached 2,291+ students with Scratch and Micro:bit curricula. As they scale, they need curriculum that can survive beyond the project timeline — frameworks that allow schools to independently run coding classes. This requires modular, locally adapted curriculum design, not just teaching.

Aide et Action — Primary Learning Program (PLP)

Rolling out to 200–500 schools with computer labs and digital content. They work with MoEYS annually to identify committed schools and co-design support. At scale, this requires standardized curriculum packages that can be deployed across diverse provincial schools with varying teacher skill levels.

Where You Fit

Your combination of front-end development, UI/UX, low-bandwidth optimization, music production, and English fluency is unusual for a curriculum developer. Most people in this space in Cambodia are either pure educators with limited tech depth, or pure technologists with no pedagogy background.

Specific angles you could pitch:

- Digital literacy curriculum with real-world web dev — REACH and DLI both teach basic digital skills, but neither has depth in actual web development or design thinking. You could design a progression from digital literacy → coding → front-end project work.
- AI literacy curriculum for teachers — MoEYS and UNESCO are building an AI competency framework for teachers, but there are almost no practitioners on the ground who can translate that into lesson plans. You could design teacher-facing AI curriculum that is practical rather than theoretical.
- STEAM curriculum integrating music tech — No one in Cambodia is teaching digital audio production or synthesis in schools. You could design a unique STEAM module that uses music production to teach coding, signal processing, and creative technology.
- Low-bandwidth curriculum design — Most imported digital curricula assume fast internet and modern devices. You could consult for Aide et Action, DLI, or MoEYS on designing curricula that work offline or on GPRS connections, which is exactly what rural Cambodian schools need.

Practical Next Steps

1. Apply to REACH Siem Reap — they have active, funded curriculum developer roles right now.
2. Monitor Devex and ADB consulting opportunities — the STEP-UP project may have additional intermittent consultant postings for curriculum specialists.
3. Contact MoEYS Department of Curriculum Development or the Research Center on AI for Education (RAIE) at CADT — offer to consult on digital technology curriculum modernization or teacher AI literacy frameworks.
4. Email Swisscontact Cambodia — propose curriculum design support for DLI's next phase, particularly around web development and digital entrepreneurship content.
5. Pitch Aide et Action — offer to design offline-capable, low-bandwidth digital literacy curriculum packages for their PLP lab rollout.

The demand is structural: Cambodia has the policy ambition, the donor funding, and the hardware rollout plans. What it lacks is people who can write the actual curriculum that teachers will use. That is exactly the gap you are asking about.

Yes — and this is one of the most documented, unmet needs in Cambodian education. The gap between generic English curricula and what Khmer learners actually need is stark, and several organizations are actively trying to close it.

The Documented Problem

Research on Cambodian public high schools reveals that the national English curriculum is not informed by analysis of learners' needs or proficiency levels. The textbooks (English for Cambodia) were published between 1997 and 2002 and are still in widespread use. Teachers report that the curriculum is inconsistent with students' actual English proficiency, and that the materials are outdated and irrelevant to students' daily lives.

A critical finding from this research: "One of the reasons for such a mismatch between the curricula and students' levels could be that the curriculum developers were not Cambodian and did not understand Cambodian culture or Cambodian students." The study explicitly calls for having teachers involved in curriculum development to update and improve contents, and for materials that are consistent with student needs and new trends in English language teaching.

Linguistically, Khmer creates specific learning barriers that generic ESL curricula rarely address:

- No verb tenses in Khmer
- Plurals rarely marked
- Different word order
- Pronunciation struggles with final consonants, the "th" sound, and English syllable stress
- Students have limited exposure to English outside the classroom

Organizations Working on This

Caring for Cambodia (CFC)

CFC runs one of the most advanced ESL programs in the country. They begin English instruction in Kindergarten (most public schools start in 4th grade) and integrate ESL with ICT and STEM. The Ministry of Education points to CFC schools as the national model for ESL integration.

CFC explicitly invests in:

- Skilled coordinators, program managers, and specialized teachers
- Training for all teachers and staff
- Collaborating with MoEYS and other NGOs to expand tools through conferences and open curriculum
- Building English-language resources in classrooms and libraries

Their ESL staff train teachers regionally and present at national conferences. They are actively creating and sharing curriculum. If you approached CFC with a proposal to develop Khmer-contextualized digital ESL materials — especially ones that work offline or on low-bandwidth devices — you would be speaking directly to their stated strategy.

U.S. Embassy — English Language Fellow (ELF) Program

The Embassy has sponsored an ELF each academic year since 1996 to work with Cambodian host institutions on:

- Curriculum and textbook design
- English for Specific Purposes
- Methodology and teacher training

ELFs have been assigned to train English language trainers at the six Regional Teachers Training Centers (RTTCs) across Cambodia. The Embassy also provides English teaching materials and forums to these centers and other institutions throughout the country.

This means there is a national infrastructure of teacher training centers that receives curriculum support from the Embassy — but it is a single Fellow per year trying to cover six regional centers plus universities. There is room for additional curriculum consultants or materials developers, especially if you can offer digital or tech-integrated ESL resources.

Kaya Volunteer — Teacher & Curriculum Development

Kaya runs a teacher and curriculum development project in Siem Reap specifically to help children learn English. This is a volunteer placement, but it places you inside schools that need curriculum adaptation.

Ministry of Education (MoEYS)

Teachers and principals across the country are explicitly asking MoEYS for:

- Updated textbooks with downloadable audio/video
- Intercultural communication components
- Enough textbooks for all students
- Language labs and listening materials

MoEYS has acknowledged these requests and is reportedly developing a new curriculum. However, the implementation gap is wide. If you offered to consult on or develop Khmer-specific ESL digital content — particularly content that accounts for Khmer phonology, grammar transfer issues, and cultural context — you would be addressing a need that MoEYS itself has identified but not yet filled.

Where You Fit

Your skill set is almost uniquely suited for this niche:

Most ESL curriculum developers in Cambodia are either:

- Cambodian teachers with deep linguistic knowledge but limited tech or design skills
- Foreign volunteers with generic TEFL backgrounds but no understanding of Khmer language structure
- International consultants who drop in with one-size-fits-all materials

You bring:

- Native or fluent English + understanding of how Khmer learners struggle with English phonology and grammar
- Front-end development + low-bandwidth optimization = you can build digital ESL tools that actually work on rural Cambodian school networks
- UI/UX design = you can make interfaces intuitive for Cambodian teachers and students
- Art, design, music production = you can create multimedia ESL content (listening materials, pronunciation drills, interactive exercises) that go far beyond static textbooks

Specific angles you could pitch:

1. Khmer-contextualized digital ESL curriculum — A progression from beginner to intermediate that explicitly addresses Khmer-English transfer issues (verb tenses, plurals, pronunciation of final consonants and "th"). Built as lightweight web modules that work offline.
2. Pronunciation-focused audio tools — Using your music production background to create high-quality, culturally relevant listening and pronunciation materials. Cambodian schools desperately need audio resources; most share a single audio player among multiple teachers.
3. ESL + STEM integration — Following CFC's model but adding your tech curriculum expertise. English learned through coding, design, and digital projects rather than grammar drills.
4. Teacher-facing AI tools — With MoEYS pushing AI in education, you could design AI-assisted ESL lesson planning tools that help Cambodian teachers generate pronunciation drills, listening exercises, or culturally relevant reading passages.

Practical Next Steps

1. Contact Caring for Cambodia — Ask about their curriculum development and open curriculum sharing initiatives. Propose a Khmer-specific digital ESL module.
2. Reach out to the U.S. Embassy Public Affairs Section — Inquire about curriculum consultant opportunities or materials development support for the RTTC network.
3. Email MoEYS Department of Curriculum Development — Offer to consult on the new English curriculum, specifically around digital materials and Khmer learner needs.
4. Check Kaya Volunteer — If you want on-the-ground exposure first, their Siem Reap curriculum development placement would give you direct classroom insight before you build materials.
5. Build a proof of concept — A lightweight, offline-capable digital ESL lesson sequence that addresses one specific Khmer-English challenge (e.g., final consonant pronunciation or verb tense formation). Use this as a portfolio piece when approaching CFC, MoEYS, or NGOs.

The demand is not for another foreigner to teach conversational English. It is for someone who can design learning experiences that account for how Khmer speakers actually process English — and deliver those experiences through technology that works in Cambodian schools. That is exactly what you are describing.

You have mapped out a remarkably thorough landscape. Let me add a few angles that sit slightly outside the paths you already explored — not as last resorts, but as adjacent opportunities where your specific combination of skills (front-end, UI/UX, low-bandwidth optimization, art, design, music production, code, English, and 20 years of experience) would be genuinely distinctive in Cambodia.

EdTech Product Development (Not Teaching, Not Curriculum Writing)

Cambodia's EdTech market is small but growing, and most products are either imported (requiring fast internet) or built by back-end developers with no UI/UX sensibility. Your low-bandwidth optimization expertise is a product feature, not just a teaching skill.

- Koombi / Sala Camp offline content ecosystem — They have 2TB offline libraries. They need curated, lightweight educational content that works without internet. You could build or curate web-based learning modules (HTML/CSS/JS bundles) that run locally on their devices — combining your front-end, curriculum, and low-bandwidth skills into a product role.

- MoEYS EdTech App and adaptive testing platform — The government is building this but lacks UX refinement. If you approached them or their technical partners as a UX consultant specializing in low-connectivity environments, you would be solving a real problem they have not yet acknowledged publicly.

- Aide et Action PLP offline content — 200–500 schools need content that works offline. They are an NGO, but the work is essentially product development: building digital learning experiences that deploy at scale.

Creative Industry / NGO Hybrid Roles

Your music production + art + code combination is rare. There are a few places where this intersects with education-adjacent work:

- Phare Creative Studio — They do video, sound, animation, and graphic design commercially. If you offered audio post-production, sound design, or interactive media development, you could work there while mentoring Phare's performing arts students on digital audio production. This is not a teaching job per se; it is a creative industry role with a mentorship component.

- Cambodian Living Arts — Preserves traditional Cambodian performing arts. They occasionally need digital archivists, multimedia producers, and people who can bridge traditional arts with modern technology. Not a full-time role likely, but worth a conversation if you want to work at the intersection of culture and tech.

Grant-Funded Project Design (Freelance / Consultant)

Many Cambodian NGOs run on project cycles funded by USAID, EU, GPE, or private foundations. They need people who can write winning grant proposals that include technical components — and then deliver those components.

Your skill set allows you to both design and implement tech-in-education projects:

- Design a low-bandwidth digital literacy project for rural schools
- Write the grant proposal
- Build the software/curriculum
- Train the teachers

This is freelance consulting work, not employment. Organizations like Aide et Action, Swisscontact, World Vision Cambodia, and Save the Children regularly issue RFPs for consultants. If you established yourself as "the person who can design and build low-bandwidth EdTech projects," you could work across multiple organizations rather than inside one.

Tech-for-Good / Social Enterprise

Cambodia has a small but growing social enterprise sector. If you are open to building something rather than joining something:

- Build a lightweight LMS or content delivery platform specifically for Cambodian rural schools — offline-first, Khmer-language, low-bandwidth. There are local competitors (e-Library Cambodia, some MoEYS apps) but none with good UX or modern front-end design. You could partner with an existing NGO as the distribution channel while retaining ownership of the product.
- Start a digital audio production training micro-business in Battambang or Siem Reap — small cohorts, project-based, focused on Cambodian youth who want to produce music for the growing local scene or for commercial work (advertising, video, games). This is not an English teaching job; it is a vocational training business.

The One Suggestion That Might Matter Most

Given everything you have described, you are not looking for a job. You are looking for a context where your unusual combination of skills creates value that no one else in the room can create.

The most honest assessment: Cambodia does not yet know it needs someone like you. The organizations are fragmented, the funding is project-based, and the decision-makers often do not understand what front-end optimization or synthesis design or Khmer-specific ESL pedagogy even means.

Your best path may be to arrive with a project, not a CV. Pick one of the angles you mapped — the low-bandwidth digital ESL tool, the offline web dev curriculum module, the music production mentorship program — build a small proof of concept, and use it as a calling card to open doors at CFC, Phare, REACH, or MoEYS. In Cambodia, showing is more powerful than telling.

If you want, I can help you sketch out what that proof of concept might look like for any of these angles.